



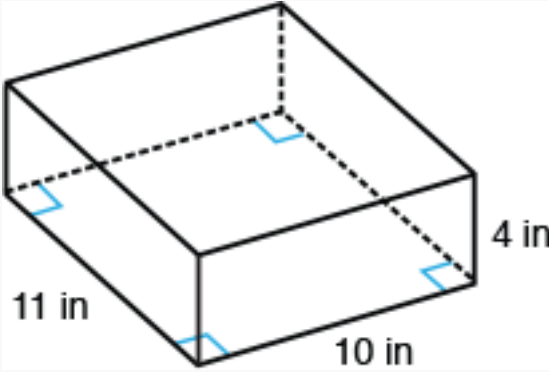
Find Surface Area by Adding

Surface area is the sum of the areas of the faces of a three-dimensional figure. You already know how to find the area of a complex figure. You can use this knowledge to find surface area.

Example

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Find the surface area of the box.



The box, a rectangular prism, has 6 faces. Each face is a rectangle that has its own length and width. Imagine unfolding the box so that the cardboard lies flat. Make sure you understand how the second drawing can be folded to make the box in the first drawing.

Step 1

Find the area of each rectangle.

- Top: $10 \times 4 = 40$
- Bottom: $10 \times 4 = 40$
- Left side: $11 \times 4 = 44$
- Right side: $11 \times 4 = 44$
- Front: $11 \times 10 = 110$
- Back: $11 \times 10 = 110$

Step 2

Add the areas of the faces.

40

40

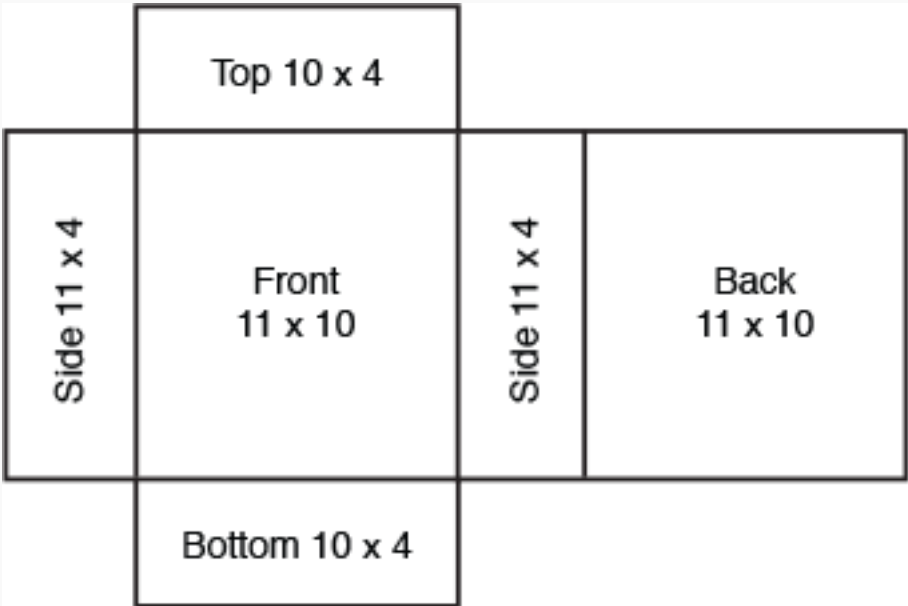
44

44

110

+110

388



The surface area of the box is **388 square inches**.

Key Term

surface area

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Category
Lesson 5: Surface Area

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